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Culture (OWC): [Luo \(FL11\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1954-1955

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Section Title(S): Ceremonial And Ritual Animals

33. The bride is now considered as a wife of the village, albeit on probation, and is given another goat, DIEND CHIEMO, or DIEND NYOKA, to allow her to eat with the other women of the village. Even today in modern weddings a bride will demand a present before she will eat with the mother of her husband or his sisters.

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34. DIERO.—The Northern Group are called JOIYI, inside group, by the rest of the Luo, who call themselves, JOOKO, or outside group, and the JOIYE have a custom which has spread to their neighbours and is still spreading to other peoples, called DIERO. It has not yet reached the Southern Luo. DIERO is described in the following paragraphs 35 and 36.

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35. The brothers of the bride have meanwhile been waiting patiently for the news that the bride has accepted the CHIENO, for now they gather their strongest and most skilled fighters from among their LIBAMBA and their neighbours to take the first head of cattle from the herd of the groom to their own village. This group is known as the JODIERO, the selectors, and they go to select a beast from the herd of the groom. The brothers of the groom naturally resist the selection and the two groups wrestle and fight mock battles with sticks until both parties agree on the beast to be taken. This animal, usually a bull, RWADH DIER, is counted as one of the bride wealth.

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DIERO.—There seems to be the greatest variation between the interpretations given to describe the RWADH DIER, perhaps because it is still in the process of being adopted by other tribes. Professor Evans-Pritchard, who worked mostly in ELEGO, in his monograph on Marriage Customs states that brothers of the bride arrive at the village the day following the defloration and they stand outside fully armed, with clubs and not with spears, and shout to the

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bride: "What do you think?" "Do you agree that we ask for a bull?" "Are you willing to stay with your husband and be his wife?" He goes on to say that the JADONG comes out with the bride and answers their questions. They then enter the kraal and point to an ox and say they want that one. The bridegroom's father then agrees to their having that animal and may or may not give it to them right away. He goes on to say that this is kept by the bride's father and counts as part of the bride wealth. Now this version is accepted by the elders of the ALEGO, GEM and UYOMA, that is the JOIYE, and some of the elders of SEME agreed to this version. The version which I have given above is the SEME, SAKWA and ASEMBO version and is accepted by the elders of KISUMU and KAJULU. The following is a variation on the same theme. A large party of women from the girl's village, having been informed of the virginity of the bride, proceed that night to the village of the groom and steal the best bull they are able to lay their hands on and make off back to their own village. One or two remain behind to dance in the  101 village of the groom and sing of their exploit at first light. My informants say that the relatives of the groom anticipate this attack. They do not make an attempt to prevent the women stealing the beast but they do ensure that their best animals are safely hidden in someone else's village. If they are caught in the act of stealing this animal or found driving it away from the village, they would be ridiculed for having chosen such a poor animal and deceived by joking that this, in fact, did not belong to the boy's family at all but was only loaned to him by a friend.

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